

E021

Leading a Technology Transformation

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A new CIO at a 3,000-employee distribution company is asked by the CEO to “do AI this year.” The company runs on a 15-year-old ERP, and no one has mapped which systems hold customer data. The CIO’s previous employer was an airline. What should the CIO do first?

- A. Copy the airline’s transformation plan.
- B. Replace the ERP immediately, since legacy systems always block change.
- C. Select an AI platform and start a pilot.
- D. Assess current systems, data, and capabilities against business goals to find the gaps.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A health network wants a predictive model for patient no-shows. Patient records are split across four systems with conflicting IDs, and access rights are managed by hand. The network recently opened a pediatric wing. What should the roadmap sequence first?

- A. Build the model on only one of the four systems.
- B. Unify patient identity and data governance, and automate access control, before the model.
- C. Start with the pediatric wing’s data.
- D. Build the model now and clean the data later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Warehouse supervisors at a 12-site retailer attended town halls, can explain why the new inventory system is coming, and say it is a good idea. In practice they still use paper because they do not know how to run cycle counts in the new screens. Their union contract renews next year. Which ADKAR element is missing?

- A. Reinforcement.
- B. Desire.
- C. Knowledge.
- D. Awareness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Staff have finished training and can use a new system well, but they do not want to give up the old one and see no benefit to themselves. Which element should the change plan target?

- A.** Desire.
- B.** Knowledge, with more training.
- C.** Reinforcement, since training is complete.
- D.** Ability.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Six weeks into a cloud migration, the first two applications moved successfully. The sponsor wants to announce the transformation is complete and disband the steering group. The project has its own Slack channel with 200 members. Under Kotter's model, what is the risk?

- A.** The Slack channel is too large for good communication.
- B.** There is no risk; two successful moves prove the plan works.
- C.** Declaring victory too soon, before the change is built on and anchored in culture.
- D.** The team skipped creating urgency.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

The CFO controls the transformation budget but has shown little interest in the details and skips project updates. She has been with the company for 22 years. On a power/interest grid, how should the transformation leader engage her?

- A.** Monitor only.
- B.** Keep informed with the full project newsletter.
- C.** Manage closely with weekly detailed meetings.
- D.** Keep satisfied: brief, targeted updates on budget and risk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Front-line call-center agents care deeply about a new CRM rollout but have little formal authority over it. Which engagement approach fits?

- A.** Monitor with minimal effort.
- B.** Keep informed, with regular updates and channels for feedback.
- C.** Ignore them, since only decision-makers matter.
- D.** Keep satisfied.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A transformation costs \$1,200,000 upfront. It saves \$500,000 a year in labor but adds a \$100,000 annual software subscription. The vendor was rated a leader by an analyst firm. What is the payback period?

- A.** 12 years
- B.** 0.33 years
- C.** 2.4 years
- D.** 3 years

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A \$900,000 project must pay back within 2.5 years. What minimum annual net benefit does it need?

- A.** \$900,000
- B.** \$2,250,000
- C.** \$360,000
- D.** \$450,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A regional bank scans its paper loan files into PDFs stored on a shared drive. The project took nine months and a new scanner fleet. The press release calls it a digital transformation. What is it actually?

- A.** Transformation, because of the time and equipment involved.
- B.** Digitization.
- C.** Digital transformation.
- D.** Digitalization.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Two months into rolling out a new field-service app to 400 technicians, the steering group wants a signal of whether the rollout is on track. Annual service revenue is reported each January. The app's icon is orange. Which measure is the best leading indicator?

- A.** Share of technicians completing jobs in the app each week.
- B.** Annual service revenue.
- C.** Number of app downloads, since installs always mean use.
- D.** Total money spent on the app.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A board wants the measure that will confirm, after the fact, whether a finished ERP transformation delivered its promised value. Which is it?

- A.** Year-over-year reduction in order-processing cost.
- B.** Training completion rate.
- C.** Number of go-live tasks finished on time.
- D.** Weekly active users in the first month.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A new CIO at a 3,000-employee distribution company is asked by the CEO to “do AI this year.” The company runs on a 15-year-old ERP, and no one has mapped which systems hold customer data. ~~The CIO’s previous employer was an airline.~~ What should the CIO do first?

Target word: first step **Decides:** The current state is unknown.

A	Camouflage	A prior employer’s plan does not fit this company’s state.
B	Absolute language	May be needed, but only an assessment can show it.
C	Inverted operation	Picks the solution before understanding the need.
D	Correct	The roadmap must close known gaps; they are not known yet.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A health network wants a predictive model for patient no-shows. Patient records are split across four systems with conflicting IDs, and access rights are managed by hand. ~~The network recently opened a pediatric wing.~~ What should the roadmap sequence first?

Target word: sequence by dependency **Decides:** The model depends on unified data and controlled access.

A	Dropped element	Leaves out most patients and the ID conflicts.
B	Correct	The model needs clean, governed data first.
C	Camouflage	The new wing does not decide the sequence.
D	Inverted operation	Reverses the dependency.

3. Answer C Concept 3

Warehouse supervisors at a 12-site retailer attended town halls, can explain why the new inventory system is coming, and say it is a good idea. In practice they still use paper because they do not know how to run cycle counts in the new screens. ~~Their union contract renews next year.~~ Which ADKAR element is missing?

Target word: first missing ADKAR element **Decides:** Awareness and desire are present; how-to is missing.

A	Adjacent category	Reinforcement sustains a change people are already making.
B	Inverted operation	They already say it is a good idea.
C	Correct	They want it but do not know how; knowledge comes next.
D	Dropped element	They already explain why the change is coming.

4. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Staff have finished training and can use a new system well, but they do not want to give up the old one and see no benefit to themselves. Which element should the change plan target?

Target word: reverse: knowledge present, desire missing **Decides:** Desire is the earliest missing element.

A	Correct	The gap is motivation, not skill.
B	Inverted operation	They already have the skill; more training will not create desire.
C	Adjacent category	Reinforcement follows adoption, which has not happened.
D	Confusion set	They can already use it well.

5. Answer C Concept 4

Six weeks into a cloud migration, the first two applications moved successfully. The sponsor wants to announce the transformation is complete and disband the steering group. ~~The project has its own Slack channel with 200 members.~~ Under Kotter's model, what is the risk?

Target word: Kotter step at risk **Decides:** Early wins are not the end; change must be sustained and anchored.

A	Camouflage	Channel size does not decide the risk.
B	Absolute language	Early success does not guarantee the rest.
C	Correct	Short-term wins should fuel more change, not end it.
D	Adjacent category	Urgency is a start-of-change step; the risk here is at the end.

6. Answer D Concept 5

The CFO controls the transformation budget but has shown little interest in the details and skips project updates. ~~She has been with the company for 22 years.~~ On a power/interest grid, how should the transformation leader engage her?

Target word: engagement strategy from the grid **Decides:** High power, low interest.

A	Dropped element	Ignores her power over the budget.
B	Confusion set	That fits low power / high interest.
C	Adjacent category	That is for high power and high interest.
D	Correct	High power / low interest calls for keeping satisfied.

7. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Front-line call-center agents care deeply about a new CRM rollout but have little formal authority over it. Which engagement approach fits?

Target word: reverse quadrant **Decides:** Low power, high interest.

A	Dropped element	Ignores their high interest.
B	Correct	Low power / high interest.
C	Absolute language	Users drive adoption.
D	Inverted operation	That is the high power / low interest quadrant.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A transformation costs \$1,200,000 upfront. It saves \$500,000 a year in labor but adds a \$100,000 annual software subscription. ~~The vendor was rated a leader by an analyst firm.~~ What is the payback period?

Target word: payback period **Decides:** Net annual benefit = \$500,000 – \$100,000 = \$400,000.

A	Wrong stem number	Divides by the subscription instead of the net benefit.
B	Inverted operation	Divides benefit by investment.
C	Dropped element	Uses gross savings and drops the subscription.
D	Correct	$\$1,200,000 / \$400,000 = 3$.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A \$900,000 project must pay back within 2.5 years. What minimum annual net benefit does it need?

Target word: solve for benefit **Decides:** Benefit = investment / payback.

A	Absolute language	Assumes it must pay back in a single year.
B	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
C	Correct	$\$900,000 / 2.5 = \$360,000$.
D	Wrong stem number	Uses 2 years instead of 2.5.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A regional bank scans its paper loan files into PDFs stored on a shared drive. ~~The project took nine months and a new scanner fleet.~~ The press release calls it a digital transformation. What is it actually?

Target word: classify the change **Decides:** Analog converted to digital; processes and model unchanged.

A	Camouflage	Effort does not decide the category.
B	Correct	Converting paper to digital files is digitization.
C	Confusion set	Nothing about the business model or customer value changed.
D	Adjacent category	That would redesign the loan process using digital tools.

11. Answer A Concept 8

Two months into rolling out a new field-service app to 400 technicians, the steering group wants a signal of whether the rollout is on track. Annual service revenue is reported each January. ~~The app's icon is orange.~~ Which measure is the best leading indicator?

Target word: leading indicator **Decides:** An early usage measure that predicts outcomes.

A	Correct	Adoption is an early signal of results.
B	Inverted operation	A lagging indicator reported months later.
C	Absolute language	Installs do not guarantee use.
D	Adjacent category	An input, not an indicator of success.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A board wants the measure that will confirm, after the fact, whether a finished ERP transformation delivered its promised value. Which is it?

Target word: reverse: pick the lagging indicator **Decides:** Confirmation after the fact is lagging.

A	Correct	A financial outcome that confirms results later.
B	Confusion set	An early, leading signal.
C	Adjacent category	A project delivery measure, not business value.
D	Inverted operation	A leading indicator of adoption.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Assess before you roadmap	A transformation starts with a current-state assessment and gap analysis against business goals; the roadmap closes named gaps.	Picking solutions before knowing the current state.	A leader wants to buy or launch something on day one.
2	Sequencing by dependency	Foundations come first: identity, security, and clean data must be in place before advanced analytics or AI that depend on them.	Launching AI on top of fragmented, ungoverned data.	Initiatives where one needs another to work.
3	ADKAR sequence	Individual change follows Awareness → Desire → Knowledge → Ability → Reinforcement; fix the first missing element.	Training (Knowledge) people who do not yet see why the change matters.	People can describe the change but do not want it — or want it but cannot do it yet.
4	Kotter's organizational change	Kotter begins with urgency and a guiding coalition, then vision, communication, removing barriers, short-term wins, and anchoring change in culture.	Declaring victory after the first win, or skipping urgency.	An early success or a stall at the start of a change.
5	Stakeholder power and interest	High power / high interest: manage closely; high power / low interest: keep satisfied; low power / high interest: keep informed; low / low: monitor.	Giving every stakeholder the same message and involvement.	A stakeholder described by influence and concern.
6	Business case and payback	Payback period = upfront investment / annual net benefit, where net benefit subtracts new recurring costs.	Using gross savings and forgetting new recurring costs.	An investment, a yearly savings figure, and a subscription or support fee.
7	Digitization vs. digitalization vs. transformation	Digitization converts analog to digital; digitalization improves processes with digital tools; digital transformation changes the business model and customer value.	Calling any scanning or software upgrade a transformation.	How much the business model changes.
8	Leading vs. lagging indicators	Leading indicators (adoption, usage, training completion) predict results; lagging indicators (revenue, cost savings) confirm them later.	Judging a transformation only by quarterly financials during rollout.	"Early signal" vs. "final outcome."

Course scope (public description): Leading a Technology Transformation will have the student act as a technology leader who is helping an organization navigate through a digital transformation. The student will assess the technological needs of the organization, roadmap its technology change, and develop a change management strategy to enable the organization to adapt to its new technology. The student will holistically consider cloud, cybersecurity, data, and AI needs or gaps for an organization to create a complete technology change plan. This course functions as a cumulative capstone for the program while also adding new content to prepare students to strategize large-scale, detailed digital transformation project. There is no prerequisite for this course.